



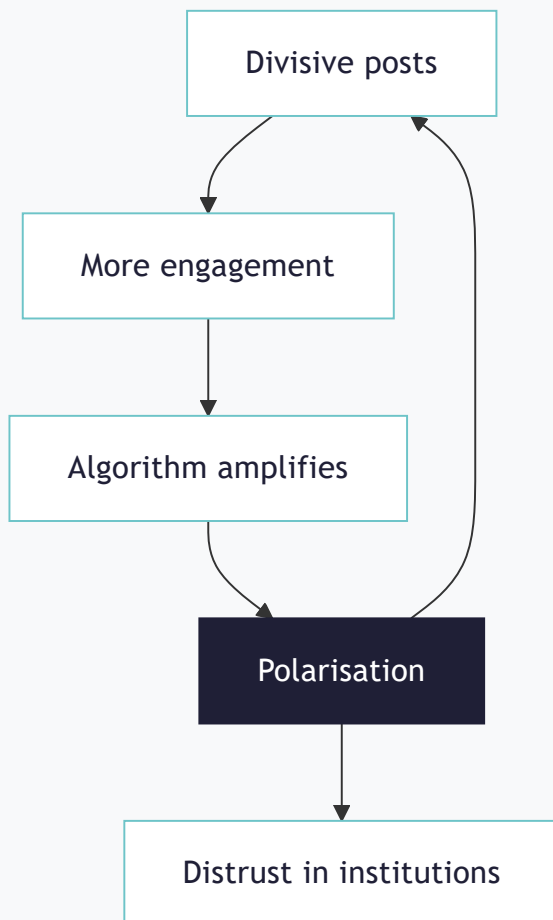
# THREE WAYS TO USE CAUSAL MAPPING

Three different ways to use causal mapping. The workflow is similar for each: import interviews and/or reports and code them (identifying all the causal claims, where someone says that one thing influences another) manually or with AI.

## General social research

### What do people think, and what drives what?

Gather open accounts on any topic and map the causal claims people make. No fixed framework: **the drivers** emerge from the material, **feedback loops** and all.

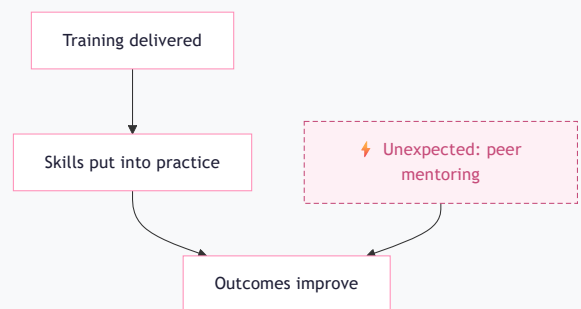


*A feedback loop driving polarisation, with a downstream branch.*

## Testing a theory of change

### Does the evidence back your theory of change?

Build a **theory of change** inductively from reports and interviews, or apply a fixed codebook from an existing theory, or mix the two approaches. Either way the map can also surface **outcomes you never expected**. Behind each link are multiple quotes from multiple sources.

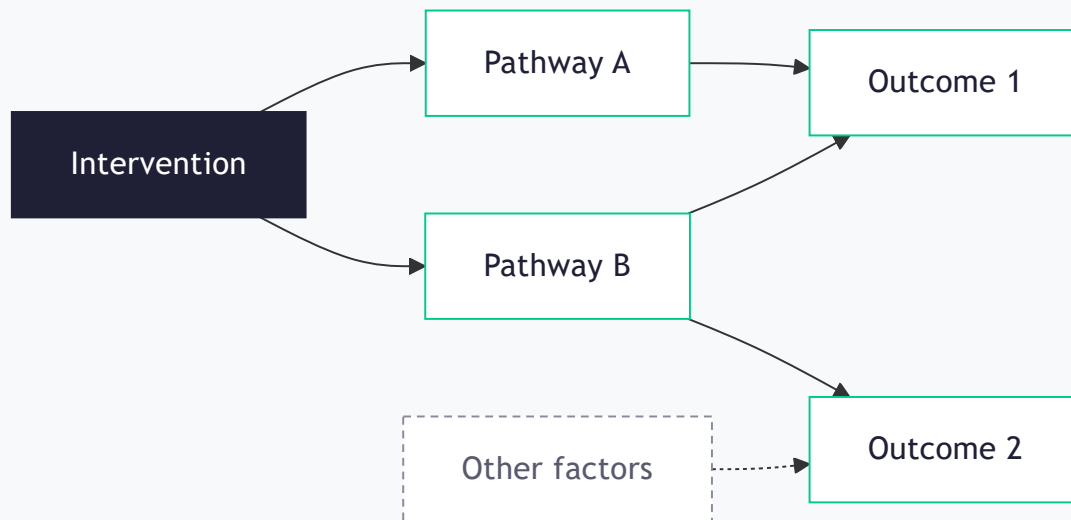


*Validating a theory of change*

## As the skeleton for an entire evaluation

## Run the whole evaluation from one coded evidence base

Import all your material, code it once, and use the map as the backbone of the study. Express each **evaluation question** as one or more filters applied to the **complete map**. Then read the answer off the evidence.



### Questions you can answer

- What is the evidence our intervention led to a given outcome?
- Along which pathways did that change happen?
- How does the story differ across groups of respondents?
- What are the alternative explanations, and how strong are they?